YOU CAN'T SERVE TWO MASTERS

Undivided Allegiance to Christ in an Age of Cultural Compromise

Drew Reitzel

SAMPLE COPY - NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION

Copyright © 2025 by Drew Reitzel

All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means—electronic, mechanical, photocopy, recording, or otherwise—without the prior written permission of the author, except as provided by United States of America copyright law.

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible (The Holy Bible, English Standard Version®), © 2001 by Crossway, a publishing ministry of Good News Publishers. ESV Text Edition: 2025. The ESV text may not be quoted in any publication made available to the public by a Creative Commons license. The ESV may not be translated in whole or in part into any other language. Used by permission. All rights reserved.

Published 2025

Undivided Allegiance Press

ISBN: 979-8-9964176-0-5

Printed in the United States of America

For information about bulk orders, speaking engagements, or ministry partnerships, visit UndividedAllegiance.com.

DIGITAL SAMPLE COPY

This sample of *You Can't Serve Two Masters* contains **Chapter 1, The Hollowing of Holiness**. It is provided free to readers of The Remnant and to those who requested it at UndividedAllegiance.com.

It may not be reproduced, uploaded, forwarded, distributed, sold, or otherwise shared without written permission from the author.

If this chapter stirred something in you, **the full book is available in paperback and ebook.** Read the rest. Then put it in the hands of someone who needs to hear it.

Drew Reitzel

Author, You Can't Serve Two Masters

https://www.undividedallegiance.com/

SAMPLE COPY NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION

Dedication

To God, whose mercy endures beyond every failure and whose grace made this book possible—not because I deserved it, but because He is faithful.

To my mother, whose prayers outlasted my wandering and whose life was the first sermon I ever heard. You showed me what it looks like to love God with your whole life, not just your words. This book exists because you never stopped believing.

And to the godly men God has placed in my path—you know who you are. Iron sharpens iron, and you have sharpened me. I am grateful beyond what words can hold.

SAMPLE COPY - NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION

Contents

SECTION ONE

The Rise of Cultural Christianity **1**

1 The Hollowing of Holiness 3
2 The Death of Discipleship 11
3 The Cult of Self and the Rise of Autonomy 19
4 The Counterfeit Church: Crowds without Conversion 27
5 A Prophetic Call to Return to the Lord 37
Conviction in Action *47*

SECTION TWO

What the Bible Actually Says **49**

6 Scripture as the Standard, Not a Suggestion 51
7 The Word of God on Truth, Morality, Identity, and Justice 63
8 The Cost of Treating Scripture as a Buffet 77
Conviction in Action *89*

SECTION THREE

Abortion and the Culture of Death **91**

9 The Sanctity of Life vs. the Right to Kill 93
10 Why "Reproductive Freedom" Is a Spiritual Deception 105
11 How Christians Have Been Complicit through Silence 119

SAMPLE COPY - NOT FOR REDISTRIBUTION

Conviction in Action *129*

SECTION FOUR

Gender, Sexuality, and the War on Creation **133**

12 God's Design vs. Gender Chaos 135
13 LGBTQ+ Ideology and the Redefinition of Love 145
14 The Fallout of Affirming What God Calls Sin 157
Conviction in Action *171*

SECTION FIVE

Love Redefined—The Hijacking of Compassion **175**

15 From Agapē to Affirmation—The Counterfeit Gospel 177
16 Tolerance as the New Golden Calf 185
17 The Love That Warns—God's Mercy Is Not Mute 193
18 Church without Conviction—How We Got Here 203
19 The False Gospel of Affirmation 211
Conviction in Action *219*

SECTION SIX

Jesus Wasn't a Socialist, and the Bible Isn't a Welfare Manifesto **223**

20 The Lie of Holy Redistribution 225
21 When Compassion Becomes Control 239
22 Why Forced Charity Isn't Christlike 253
Conviction in Action *267*

SECTION SEVEN

The Progressive Gospel **271**

23 Woke at the Altar—How Wokeness Crept into the Pulpit 273
24 Redefining Sin, Justice, and Jesus 281
25 The Counterfeit Christ: Why the Inclusive Jesus Isn't Jesus at All 291
26 The Assault on the Family 299
Conviction in Action *309*

SAMPLE NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION

SECTION EIGHT

Behind the Curtain—The Spirit Driving the Agenda **313**

27 The War We Cannot See—Spiritual Conflict beneath Political Chaos 315

28 Principalities behind Policies: From Molech to Modernity 329

29 Discernment Lost: When the Church Forgets How to See 341

Conviction in Action *351*

SECTION NINE

Stop Playing Defense—Christians Must Reclaim Boldness **355**

30 Silence Is Surrender 357

31 Truth in Love, Not Love without Truth 367

32 The Remnant Who Won't Bow 379

Conviction in Action *391*

SECTION TEN

Living Unshaken in a Hostile Culture **395**

33 Building a Life Grounded in Scripture, Not Systems 397

34 Raising Children Who Aren't Cultural Hostages 407

35 Creating a Legacy That Honors Christ and Resists Compromise 419

Conviction in Action *431*

About the Author **435**

Endnotes **437**

SAMPLE COPY NOT FOR REDISTRIBUTION

SAMPLE COPY - NOT FOR REDISTRIBUTION

CHAPTER 1

The Hollowing of Holiness

The crisis of the American church did not arrive like a sudden storm. It emerged like a slow leak beneath the floorboards, unnoticed at first, tolerated next, and eventually treated as normal. The landscape of modern Christianity is now littered not with the fruit of repentance but with the debris of compromise, shaped less by persecution pressing in from without than by corrosion rising from within. This is not chiefly the age of open rebellion against God but of gradual drift, quiet accommodation, and dignified apostasy. The tragedy is not that the world has rejected truth; the tragedy is that the church has grown comfortable without it.

The vocabulary of faith remains familiar: grace, repentance, holiness, obedience. But the meaning of these words has been drained, reshaped, and repurposed to satisfy a culture that elevates affirmation above surrender and self-expression above submission. If one can claim salvation without submission, faith without faithfulness, or belief without obedience, then Christianity becomes a label rather than a life, an affiliation rather than a rebirth. And when faith is reduced to self-identification, it becomes indistinguishable from the culture it was meant to confront. Scripture does not

recognize such a faith. It declares plainly, *"Having the appearance of godliness, but denying its power."* (2 Timothy 3:5). Appearance without power is not weakness; it is deception.

The unraveling of spiritual conviction began when the church traded the fear of the Lord for the approval of men. Reverence was quietly replaced with relevance, and the pulpit, once a furnace that refined the saints, cooled into a stage that entertains spectators. The call to holiness, once thundered with apostolic authority, was softened into suggestions for self-improvement. Pastors once trained to rightly handle the word of truth (2 Timothy 2:15) became managers of religious sentiment, shaping their messages to avoid offense, preserve attendance, and maintain institutional peace. A church that no longer trembles before God will inevitably tremble before culture, donors, critics, and the shifting winds of ideology. Grace becomes a blanket for rebellion rather than the power to overcome it. Faith becomes an accessory rather than a summons to allegiance. Sin becomes a misstep instead of spiritual treason. Christ becomes a consultant instead of a King.

This collapse was not accidental. Thomas Watson warned centuries ago that the fear of God drives out every other base fear, and a people that loses its reverence for God loses with it the courage to stand against the tide of its age.[1] When the fear of the Lord evaporates, so do wisdom, discernment, and conviction. Scripture declares without apology, *"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom."* (Proverbs 9:10). The fear of the Lord is the foundation of everything else. When it collapses, wisdom goes with it, and when wisdom goes, moral clarity follows. The most basic tenets of Christian morality become negotiable; sexuality, marriage, gender, justice, truth,

and holiness are treated as matters of personal interpretation rather than divine decree. The church begins to mirror the culture rather than confront it. But Scripture has never granted permission to adjust righteousness to the temperature of the times.

The American church's descent into sentimentalism accelerated as her understanding of God Himself shifted. The biblical portrait of the Almighty—holy, sovereign, righteous, and consuming—was domesticated into a deity whose primary attribute is therapeutic comfort. God's holiness became a footnote. His justice became an embarrassment. His sovereignty became a philosophical inconvenience. What remained was a god fashioned in the image of Western sentimentality: affirming, indulgent, and harmless. R. C. Sproul named sin for what it is: cosmic treason against a holy God.[2] A god who makes no demands produces worshipers who have no convictions, and a Christ stripped of holiness cannot save anyone from sin. Such a Christ offends no one, transforms no one, and judges no one. And a Christ without judgment inevitably produces a Christianity without conviction.

Every era has its idols, but today's idol is autonomy, the enthronement of the self as ultimate authority. The church, desperate not to appear outdated or oppressive, subtly sanctified this idol. Rather than calling sinners to bow before Christ, she began suggesting that Christ bends toward their preferences. The gospel was reframed not as rescue from sin but as validation of identity. The church stopped asking, "What does God require?" and began asking, "What will people tolerate?" This inversion was not theological evolution; it was theological surrender. Tertullian told Rome that Christians alone keep from sin because they know

themselves to be under the eye of an all-seeing God and foresee an eternal punishment.[3] Take that weight away, and sin grows bold and the conscience dulls.

The modern believer often seeks the benefits of the cross without the burden of it, the comfort of God's promises without the confrontation of His authority, and the warmth of His compassion without the weight of His commandments. It is not ignorance alone that produces a hollow Christianity, but a willful refusal to yield. Cloaked in religious language and Christian sentiment, this refusal has produced a faith that outwardly honors Christ while inwardly dethroning Him.

Even secular observers recognize what the church has refused to confront. Jonathan Haidt, analyzing the moral mind from outside the faith, has shown that intuitions come first and strategic reasoning second, so that emotional resonance is mistaken for moral legitimacy.[4] Churches, eager to appear compassionate, have quietly absorbed this confusion. But compassion divorced from truth is neither love nor mercy; it is surrender. A church that affirms what God condemns cannot claim to represent Him.

The consequences of this shift are visible everywhere. Churches swell in attendance but shrink in holiness. Worship is loud, but lives are unchanged. The metrics of success—attendance, giving, and engagement—replace the biblical metrics of fruitfulness, repentance, and righteousness. Programs expand while prayer meetings disappear. The crisis is not that the world is dark; the crisis is that the church has grown dim. The lampstand meant to shine has been smothered by compromise. The salt meant to preserve has lost its distinctiveness. A compromised church cannot confront a corrupt culture; she can only mirror it.

At the root of this collapse lies a catastrophic misunderstanding of the gospel itself. The gospel is not an invitation to self-fulfillment but a declaration of spiritual bankruptcy. It does not affirm the old life; it demands its death. It does not coexist with sin; it conquers it. It does not negotiate with rebellion; it crucifies it. *"I have been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me."* (Galatians 2:20). These are not poetic metaphors for sentimental reflection; they are declarations of death. When the gospel is reframed as inspirational messaging rather than divine intervention, sin becomes a habit to manage rather than a master to overthrow. Repentance becomes optional instead of essential. Discipleship becomes recommended rather than required. Holiness becomes extreme instead of expected.

The church forgot that salvation is not a transaction but a transformation, not the mere removal of guilt but the remaking of the soul. It is the supernatural invasion of divine life into the dead heart of a sinner. When Christ becomes Lord, regeneration produces evidence. Grace produces godliness. Where these are absent, salvation is absent—not weakened but absent. Jonathan Edwards understood this with surgical precision: holy practice is the chief of all the signs of a sincere profession, not only to the world but to a man's own conscience.[5] The crowds that filled American churches for generations may have possessed religious fervor, but fervor without fruit is not faith.

This truth has been obscured by leaders who fear that preaching holiness will repel crowds. Yet the crowds Jesus drew were the ones who left when He spoke plainly. When He declared, *"Whoever does not take his cross and follow me is not worthy of me"* (Matthew 10:38), He was not courting a

crowd. The true Jesus offends flesh, confronts pride, and exposes hypocrisy. He is not safe, manageable, or available as a mascot for political or cultural identity. He is Lord, and His lordship demands surrender.

The modern church's aversion to confrontation has left a spiritual vacuum where conviction should dwell. People confess Jesus with their mouths while denying Him with their lives. Services are attended by people who never pursue sanctification. Crosses are worn by people who refuse crucifixion. Yet the gospel declares that only those who die with Christ will rise with Him. Anything less is counterfeit Christianity, an emotional experience without spiritual rebirth, a cultural identity without eternal transformation.

The eternal stakes are chilling: hell will be filled not only with rebels but also with the "almost persuaded," those who were close to truth but never surrendered to it.

Jesus' words remain eternally confronting: *"Why do you call me 'Lord, Lord,' and not do what I tell you?"* (Luke 6:46). He does not ask this question to condemn but to expose; calling Him Lord without treating Him as Lord is a contradiction heaven will not recognize. It is spiritual lip service, religious performance, and moral pretense. True lordship is not declared; it is demonstrated, not by enthusiasm in worship but by obedience in private, not by emotional fervor but by moral surrender, not by doctrinal agreement but by transformed desires. The church lost this clarity when she began measuring faith by expressions rather than fruit.

The confusion deepens because many assume that fruit refers only to visible works—acts of service, charity, prayer, ministry involvement, or spiritual activity. But the fruit

Scripture emphasizes is internal: humility, holiness, self-denial, purity, love of righteousness, hatred of sin, perseverance in truth, and conformity to Christ. These fruits cannot be manufactured through discipline or personality; the Spirit produces them in those who have truly died to themselves. This is why Jesus warns that *"every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire"* (Matthew 7:19). The absence of fruit is not evidence of immaturity but evidence of unbelief. No branch connected to the Vine remains barren. No soul indwelt by the Spirit remains untransformed. No heart surrendered to Christ remains unchanged.

The calamity now confronting the American church cannot be understood merely as institutional decline or moral drift; it must be recognized as the logical consequence of abandoning the God of Scripture. When a people redefine God, they inevitably redefine themselves; and when they redefine themselves, they inevitably redefine righteousness. The result is a church that speaks in Christian terms while thinking in secular categories, a church fluent in spiritual talk but foreign to spiritual power. Such religion can imitate devotion but cannot produce transformation. It can stir emotion but cannot raise the dead.

Survey data confirms what Scripture already declares. Albert Mohler calls it the scandal of biblical illiteracy: by Barna's count, 60 percent of Americans cannot name even five of the Ten Commandments, and 82 percent believe "God helps those who help themselves" is a Bible verse.[6] In the 2020 State of Theology survey, 52 percent of American adults agreed that Jesus was a great teacher but not God, and 48 percent said the Bible contains helpful accounts of ancient myths but is not literally true.[7] These are not statistics; they

are symptoms of spiritual death masquerading as religious life. When Scripture loses authority, Christ loses lordship. When Christ loses lordship, the church loses identity.

Yet even in this crisis, hope is not lost. God has always preserved a remnant, not a remnant of perfect people, but of surrendered people. And in our time, God is raising a remnant again: men and women who feel the weight of His holiness, who tremble at His Word, who refuse to bow to cultural idols, who seek revival not through innovation but through repentance. These are the ones who understand that awakening does not begin in the world but in the church. God Himself identifies them:

"This is the one to whom I will look: he who is humble and contrite in spirit and trembles at my word." (Isaiah 66:2).

This is the call: not to diagnose the crisis but to awaken the conscience. The church must rediscover the God of Scripture: the God who is holy, sovereign, and uncompromising; the God who calls sinners not to adjustment but to death; the God who demands allegiance, obedience, and repentance; the God who will not bless a church that refuses to bow. Christianity without lordship is not Christianity. Faith without fruit is not faith. Identity without obedience is not discipleship. And a church without holiness is not the Bride of Christ.

The line is drawn. The hour is late. The crisis is real. But so is the promise of renewal. For the God who judges also restores, and the God who exposes also revives. *"For it is time for judgment to begin at the household of God."* (1 Peter 4:17). If His people will bow, He will heal. If His church will repent, He will return with power. And if the remnant will rise, the darkness of our age will not have the final word.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Drew Reitzel holds a degree in theology and spent several years in pastoral ministry before entering the marketplace, where he has worked for the past twenty-five years. He writes as someone who has lived on both sides of the pulpit and the pew—who has known the mountaintop and the valley, carried his own cross, and understands what it means to love God and still struggle to obey Him.

This book was not written from a place of arrival. It was written from a place of conviction—forged through personal failure, sustained by God's mercy, and driven by an unshakable belief that the church still has time to turn.

His prayer is that these pages do not sit on a shelf. That they disturb, convict, and ultimately drive you back to your knees—and back to the God who is still waiting, still merciful, and still able to rebuild what compromise has broken. That you leave these pages with the courage to speak where you have been silent, to stand where you have been retreating, and to carry truth into every room you enter—your home, your workplace, your community, and your nation. The healing of this nation will not come from Washington. It will not come from a platform or a movement. It will come when the people of God decide that His Word is the final authority on every question, in every arena, without apology and without retreat. You are not called to be comfortable. You are called to be faithful. And faithfulness, sustained by repentance and fueled by grace, is still the most dangerous force on earth.

The remnant is rising. The only question is whether you will be counted among them.

SAMPLE COPY - NOT FOR REDISTRIBUTION

ENDNOTES

1 Thomas Watson, *A Body of Practical Divinity* (Glasgow: Blackie and Son, 1859), 47.

2 R. C. Sproul, *The Holiness of God* (Wheaton, IL: Tyndale House, 1985), 151.

3 Tertullian, *Apology* 45, trans. S. Thelwall, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 3, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Buffalo: Christian Literature Publishing, 1885), 50.

4 Jonathan Haidt, *The Righteous Mind: Why Good People Are Divided by Politics and Religion* (New York: Pantheon Books, 2012), 50.

5 Jonathan Edwards, *A Treatise concerning Religious Affections* (Boston: S. Kneeland and T. Green, 1746), 324.

6 R. Albert Mohler Jr., "The Scandal of Biblical Illiteracy: It's Our Problem," AlbertMohler.com, January 20, 2016, https://albertmohler.com/2016/01/20/the-scandal-of-biblical-illiteracy-its-our-problem-4.

7 Aaron Earls, "Americans Hold Complex, Conflicting Religious Beliefs, According to Latest State of Theology Study," Lifeway Research, September 8, 2020, https://news.lifeway.com/2020/09/08/americans-hold-complex-conflicting-religious-beliefs-according-to-latest-state-of-theology-study/.

SAMPLE COPY - NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION